

Groww Starter: designing Groww for the Gen Z investor

[Ayansh]

My take on the problem

Getting 20-26 year olds to open an account is largely solved. The harder problem is what happens after. A first-time investor with a first paycheck, a stipend or part-time income usually starts small, with no emergency savings and often after a reel or a friend's tip. Usually, two things go wrong:

- **They quit early.** The first dip or a month-end cash crunch makes stopping the SIP feel like a safe move. Without emergency funds, any surprise bill forces a withdrawal.
- **They start without understanding.** Too many choices, unfamiliar jargon, and an anxiousness that comes from an app that looks like it's built for traders.

I prioritised quitting first because the user has already taken the hardest step: starting.

So for me, success means:

First-time investors aged 20–26 make an appropriate first investment and stay invested through their first 90 days.

- **North star metric:** the share of first-time investors whose first SIP is active or paused, rather than stopped, at day 90.
- **Guardrail metrics:** re-stops within 7 days of the stop screen, intraday/F&O adoption among new users, and notification opt-outs.

Assumptions

- Groww cares most about keeping this group and their long-term value, not more sign-ups.
- Products stay as they are today: mutual funds and stocks.
- I designed it for one person. Riya is 22, takes home ₹28,000, has no emergency fund/cushion, and nearly stopped her first SIP at -6% when rent was due. (I have also included 4 different personas to show how the experience can adapt to different GenZ financial situations.)
- A student with irregular income and a part-timer saving for a laptop or any other goal in mind are served by the same features.

In scope

- **Stocks in beginner mode:** delivery-only, with a user-set stock budget.
Pro tools: unlocked by passing a five-question quick check, not by paying.
- **Supporting features include** a dashboard of the user's own money only, Payday Split, goals, stocks in beginner mode with a short quick check and a user-set stock budget, "What made you pick this?" with a tip check, milestone cards and event-based notifications.

Out of scope

- Real money, KYC, payments, a backend and live market data. Everything is simulated and labelled illustrative.
- New regulated products, F&O or intraday trading, margin, US stocks, IPOs, tax tools and loans.
- Features I scored and rejected as vanity: streaks, leaderboards, confetti, "Future You" return projections, a yearly recap, UPI round-ups, paper trading, group pots and gifting.
- Social feeds and a chatbot.

My solution and why

Groww Starter turns a small, uneven first income into a lasting habit. It explains every decision, and it offers a lighter option at the moment someone wants to quit.

1. **Money check-in → starter plan.** Six questions produce a starter shortlist, not advice. The plan shows categories, and the user picks the fund, and every reason quotes the user's own answers. This solves "**where do I start**" and the missing emergency fund cushion all together.
2. **Three questions on every money screen. What is this? Why am I seeing this? What happens next?** Every jargon word can be tapped for a one-line meaning.
3. **Flexible SIP from ₹100.** Free until 3 working days before the debit, pause for 1-3 months, change the amount, or step it up.
4. **Weekly dip note.** It gives plain ₹ and % figures in a calm tone, and the user's own losses use a soft rose, never alarm red. In a bigger dip, Steady mode makes the experience calmer and hides upsells.
5. **Guardrails for stock curiosity.** Delivery-only beginner mode, a stock budget the user sets, and a Tip Check inside the buy flow.

Why this and not something else

I scored every feature with RICE, MoSCoW frameworks and a four-question vanity check:

- Does it move the north star?
- Does it solve a top pain point?
- Would users still be better off if Groww pushed it hard?

I cut features that reward frequency or read like return promises, even when their scores were decent.

If a first-timer understands what they hold, has a emergency fund, and is offered skip or pause at the moment they want to stop, they stay invested through their first dip and first cash crunch.

“My main aim was for the User to feel a more **“Guided Flow, instead of Recommended”** in line with the policy restrictions and thus make more **Informed Choices.** ”

App Link - <https://ayanshs007.github.io/groww-starter/>

Reviewer_README- https://github.com/ayanshS007/groww-starter/blob/main/REVIEWER_README.md

Github link - <https://github.com/ayanshS007/groww-starter>

Prompt Link - https://github.com/ayanshS007/groww-starter/blob/main/PROMPT_LOG.md

Eval - <https://github.com/ayanshS007/groww-starter/blob/main/evals/EVALS.md>